



The Sociology of Contemporary Analytic Philosophy

CASE STUDY 1

INTRODUCTION

1) Production in analytic philosophy:

1.1) Who are the most productive philosophers?

1.2) Which are the most productive institutions? And in which countries are they based?

INTRODUCTION

2) Informal collaboration in analytic philosophy:

2.1) How many informal collaborators does the average analytic philosopher mention?

2.2) Is informal collaboration common in analytic philosophy?

INTRODUCTION

3) Prestige in the analytic philosophy community:

3.1) Who are the most mentioned philosophers?

3.2) Who are the most mentioned philosophers within the various sub-areas of analytic philosophy?

3.3) How are mentions distributed among the members of the community?

3.4) Are mentions correlated with other indicators of prestige (e.g. number of citations or number of published articles)?

3.5) Does gender affect the chances of accumulating mentions?

METHODOLOGY:

1. Production in Analytic Philosophy

1.1) Who are the most productive philosophers?

- a) **Interpretation:** productivity as the number of distinct articles a philosopher authored within this database. Computed by joining Authorships_df and Philosophers_df on Phi_ID.
- b) **Data quality:** No missing identifiers, no duplicate authorship records.
- c) **Analysis:** Identification of the 10 most productive philosophers (ties included).

METHODOLOGY:

1. Production in Analytic Philosophy

1.2) Which are the most productive institutions? And in which countries are they based?

- a) **Interpretation:** productivity as the number of distinct articles associated with each institution, computed by joining Authorships_df and Affiliations_df on Inst_ID. This measure is not mutually exclusive across institutions.
- b) **Data quality:** I checked for missing institutional affiliations in the authorship records (1.4%). Rows with missing Inst_ID were excluded from the analysis.
- c) **Analysis:** For each institution, I counted the number of distinct articles associated with it, then identified the ten most productive institutions and their geography, accounting also for ties.

METHODOLOGY:

2. Informal Collaboration

2.1) How many informal collaborators does the average analytic philosopher mention?

- a) **Interpretation:** informal collaborators as distinct acknowledgees per article. Two interpretations proposed: (1) philosopher-level — averaged within each philosopher first, then across philosophers (via `Authorships_df`), avoiding overweighting prolific authors; (2) article-level — averaged directly over articles.
- b) **Data quality:** 128 of 2,075 articles have no acknowledgments section (excluded); 103 have a section but name no philosopher (included and coded as 0).
- c) **Analysis:** for each article with acknowledgments section, I counted its distinct acknowledgees with respect to the two units of analysis discussed above (philosophers and articles). I also report the mean, median, and mode for each version.

METHODOLOGY:

2. Informal Collaboration

2.2) Is informal collaboration common in analytic philosophy?

- a) **Interpretation:** prevalence as the proportion of articles and philosophers with at least one informal collaborator. Both levels are reported, since they capture different aspects of "commonness."
- b) **Data quality:** I reuse the cleaned data from 2.1.
- c) **Analysis:** I computed the share of articles with at least one acknowledgee, out of those with an observable acknowledgments section, and the share of philosophers with at least one such article among their own work.

METHODOLOGY:

3. Prestige

3.1) Who are the most mentioned philosophers?

- a) **Interpretation:** "most mentioned" as the number of distinct articles in which a philosopher is named in the acknowledgments section. Acknowledgments_df is used to identify which philosophers are mentioned in which articles and Philosophers_df to retrieve full names.
- b) **Data quality:** I de-duplicated on Art_ID - Phi_ID before counting, since Acknowledgments_df contains 144 rows where the same philosopher is named more than once within a single article's acknowledgments.
- c) **Analysis:** For each philosopher, I counted the number of distinct articles mentioning them, and identified the ten most mentioned, while preserving ties.

METHODOLOGY:

3. Prestige

3.2) Who are the most mentioned philosophers within the various sub-areas of analytic philosophy?

- a) **Interpretation:** I analysed "sub-areas" using the Research_Area field in Articles_df. I attributed each acknowledgment mention to the sub-area of the article it comes from, and ranked philosophers by mentions separately within each sub-area.
- b) **Data quality:** As in 3.1, I de-duplicated Art_ID - Phi_ID pairs before counting. Moreover, articles lacking a sub-area are excluded from this analysis.
- c) **Analysis:** I identified the three most mentioned philosophers within each sub-area, using a tie-preserving cutoff.

METHODOLOGY:

3. Prestige

3.3) How are mentions distributed among the members of the community?

- a) **Interpretation:** "community" as the full population of philosophers recorded in the database (Philosophers_df). Philosophers never mentioned in Acknowledgments_df are coded as zero.
- b) **Data quality:** as in 3.1 and 3.2 mentions were de-duplicated on Art_ID – Phi_ID before counting.
- c) **Analysis:** I computed the mean, median, mode, and standard deviation of the number of mentions across the full population of philosophers.

METHODOLOGY:

3. Prestige

3.4) Are mentions correlated with other indicators of prestige (e.g. number of citations or number of published articles)?

- a) **Interpretation:** I used three variables as plausible prestige indicators: career-wide Citations and Publications (both from Philosophers_df), and N_Articles (the productivity measure from RQ 1). Moreover, correlation is measured as the R^2 of linear regression.
- b) **Data quality:** Citations/Publications are missing for 45% of philosophers (incomplete Scopus matching); models fit on different sample sizes as a result.
- c) **Analysis:** I computed, for each prestige indicator, three separate linear regressions and R^2 .

METHODOLOGY:

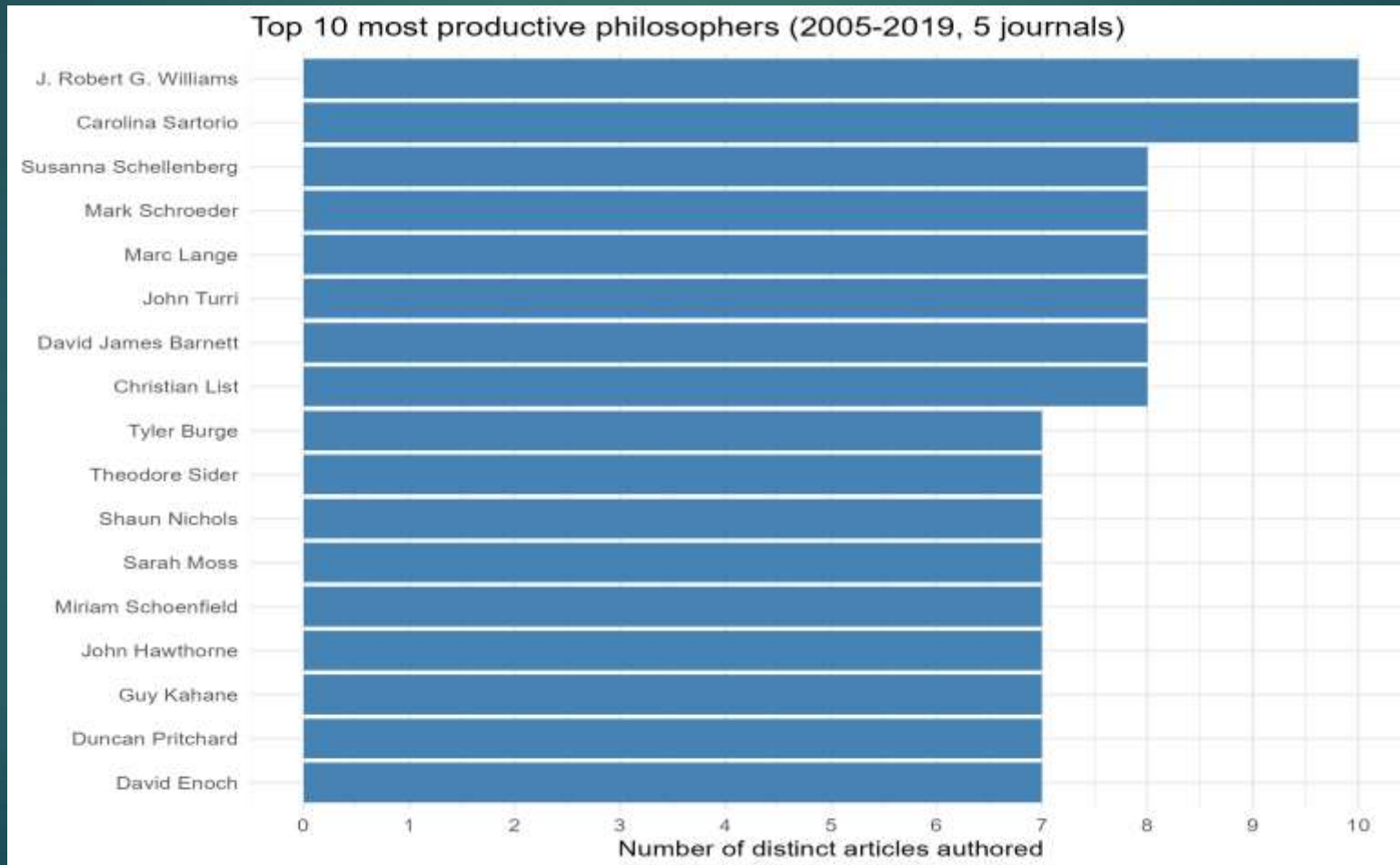
3. Prestige

3.5) Does gender affect the chances of accumulating mentions?

- a) **Interpretation:** The analysis is defined over the full population of philosophers with known gender.
- b) **Data quality:** 92 philosophers (1.5%) with unknown gender are excluded; never-mentioned philosophers are coded as 0, as in 3.3.
- c) **Analysis:** I segmented the population into four mention tiers (below/at/above median and 10%) based on the median and 90th percentile, and computed the number and percentage of women and men within each tier.

RESULTS:

1.1 Most productive philosophers



RESULTS:

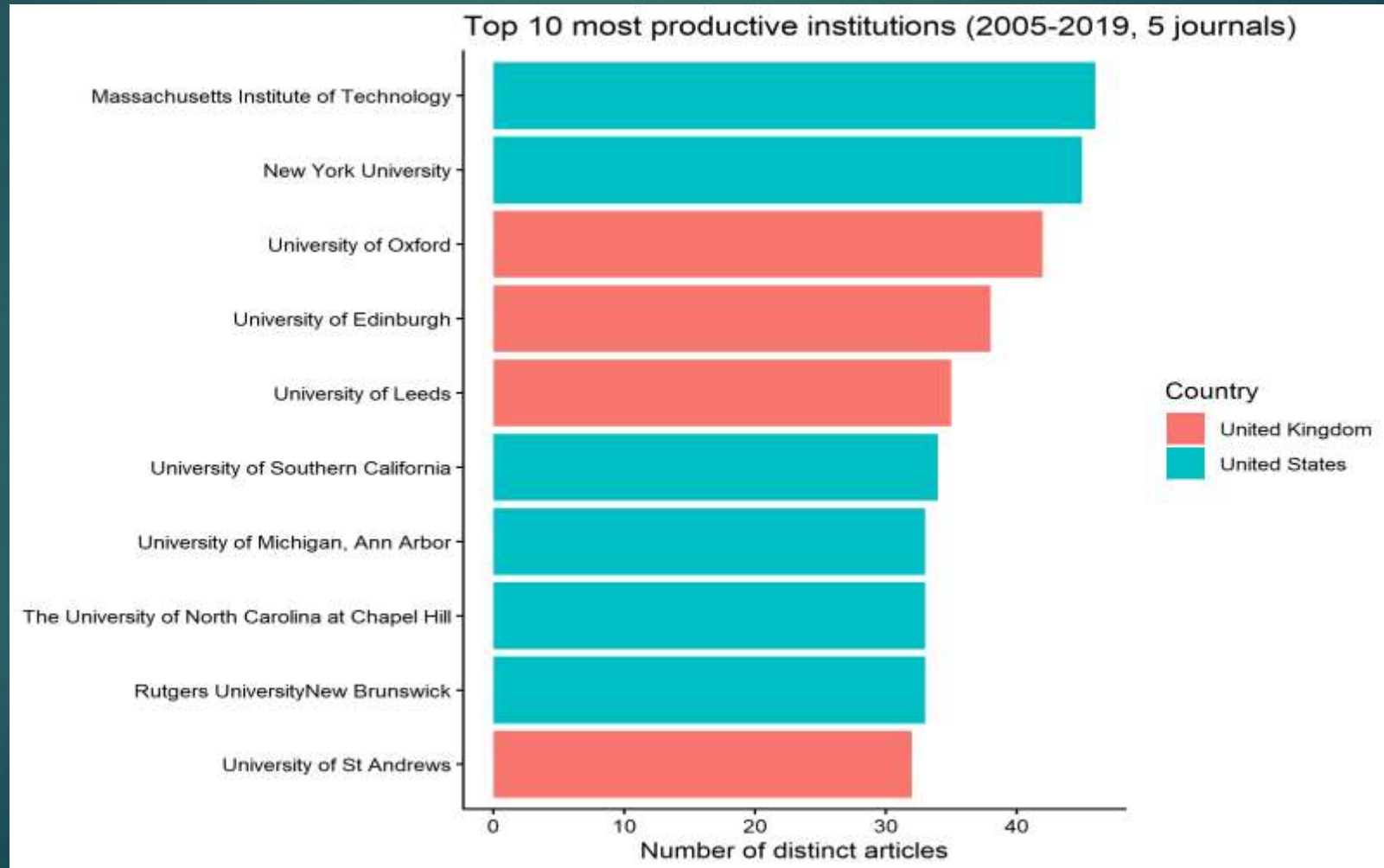
1.1 Most productive philosophers (top_philosophers)

Rank	Philosopher	N Articles
1	J. Robert G. Williams	10
2	Carolina Sartorio	10
3	John Turri	8
4	Marc Lange	8
5	Mark Schroeder	8
6	David J. Barnett	8
7	Christian List	8
8	Susanna Schellenberg	8

Rank	Philosopher	N Articles
9	Sarah Moss	7
10	Theodore Sider	7
11	David Enoch	7
12	Duncan Pritchard	7
13	John Hawthorne	7
14	Tyler Burge	7
15	Guy Kahane	7
16	Mirian Schoenfield	7
17	Shaun Nichols	7

RESULTS:

1.2 Most productive institutions and their geography



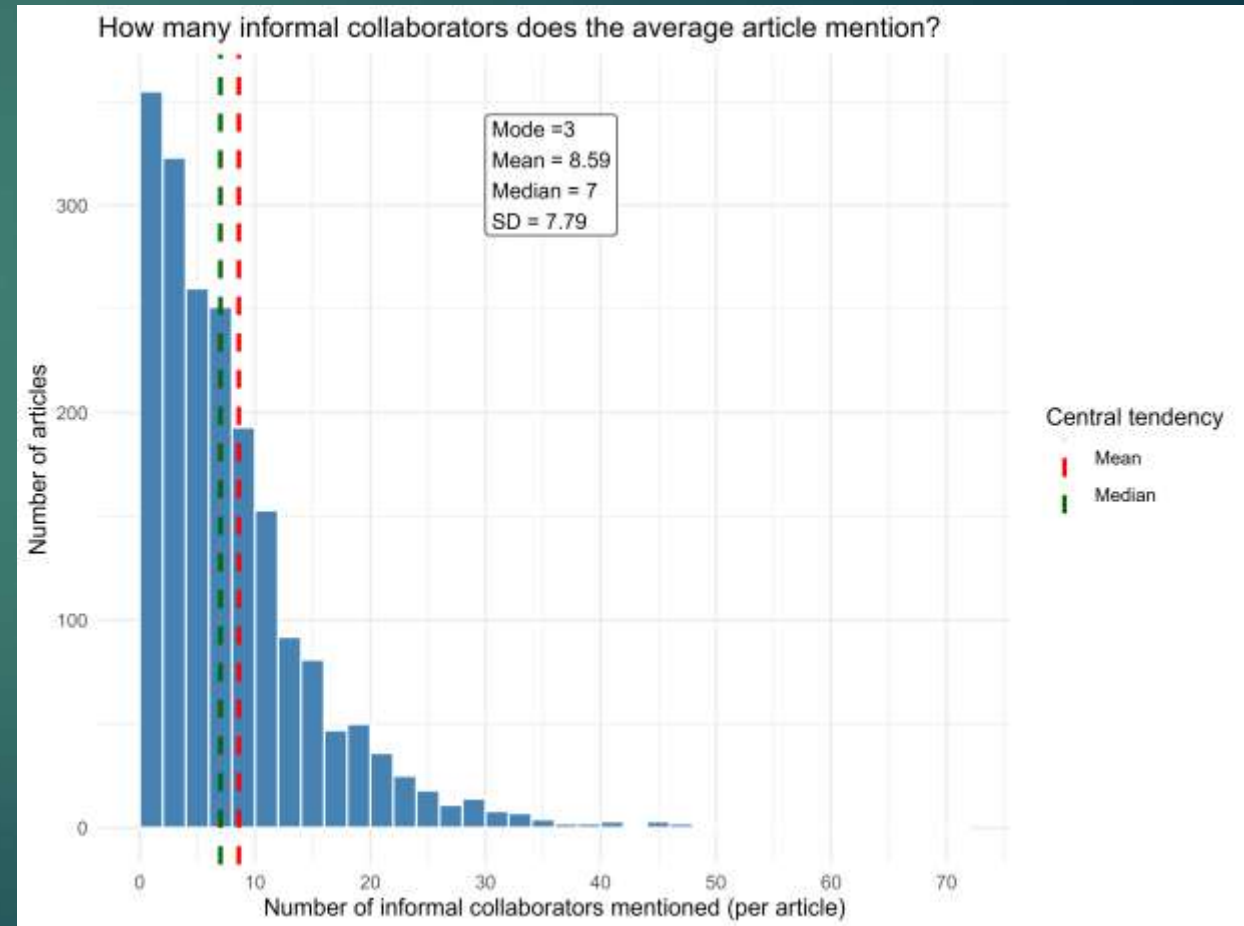
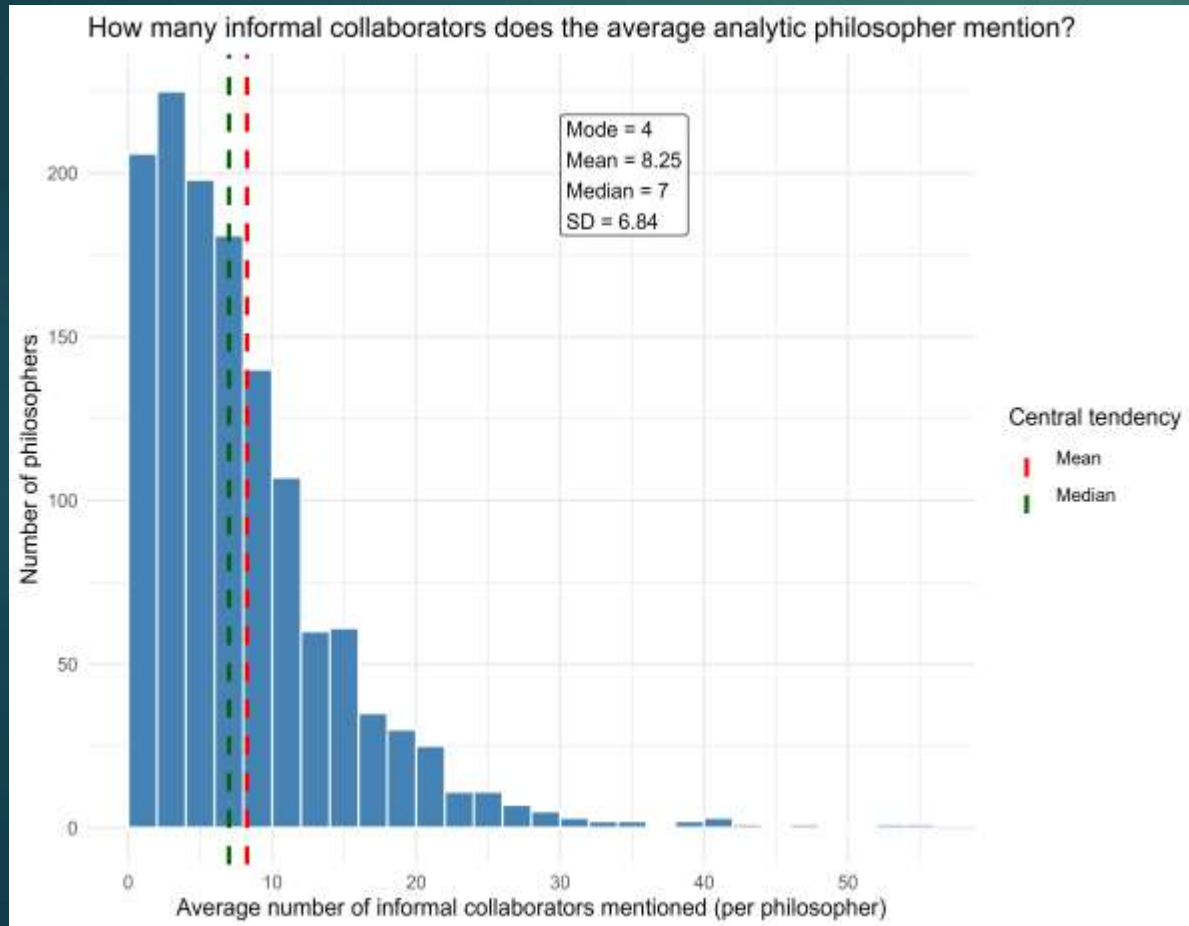
RESULTS:

1.2 Most productive institutions and their geography (top_institutions)

Affiliation name	Affiliation country	N Articles
Massachussets Institute of Technology	United States	46
New York University	United States	45
University of Oxford	United Kingdom	42
University of Edinburgh	United Kingdom	38
University of Leeds	United Kingdom	35
University of Southern California	United States	34
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	United States	33
The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	United States	33
Rutgers University-New Brunswick	United States	33
University of St Andrews	United Kingdom	32

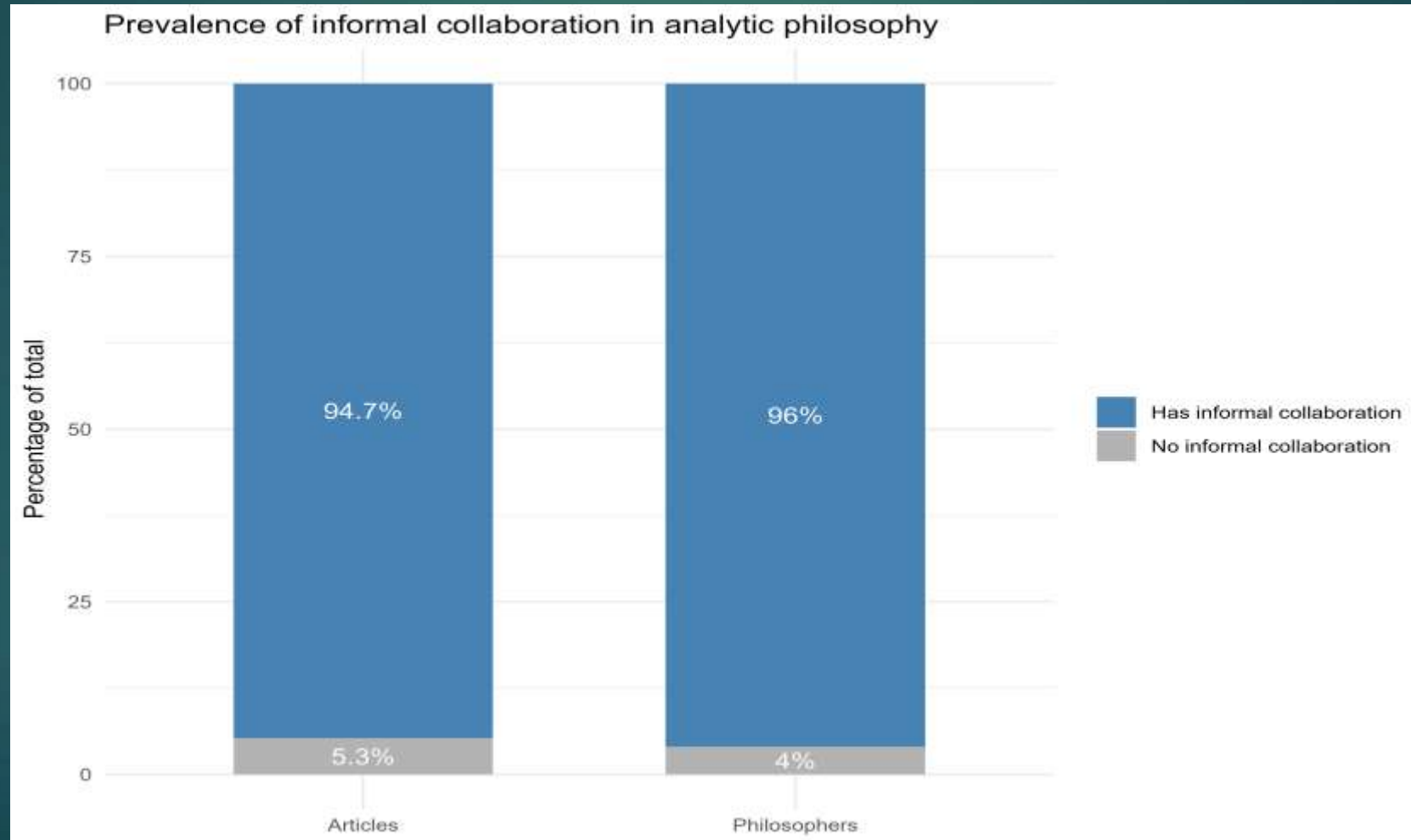
RESULTS:

2.1 How many informal collaborators does the average analytic philosopher mention?



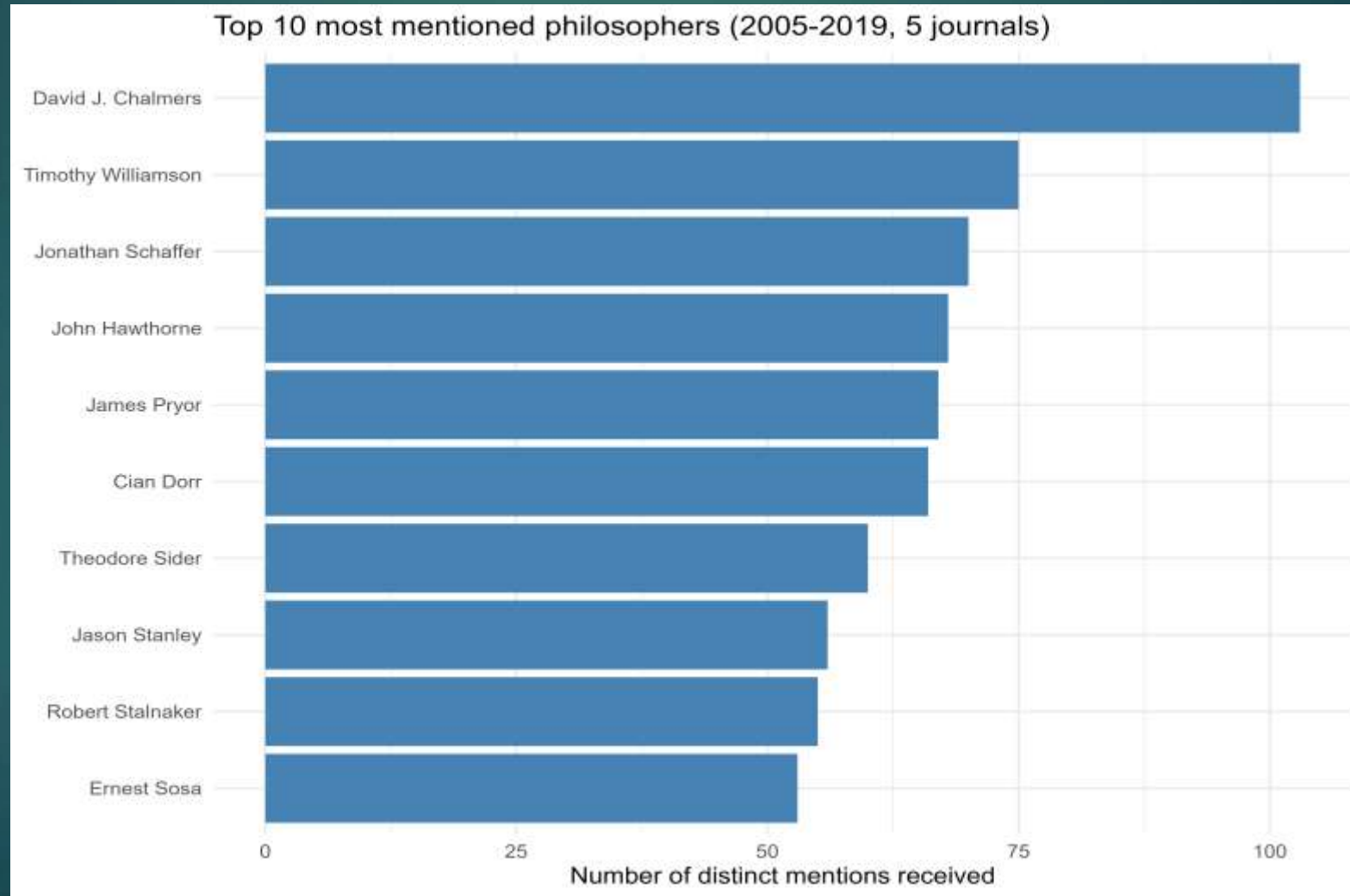
RESULTS:

2.2 Is informal collaboration common in analytic philosophy?



RESULTS:

3.1 Who are the most mentioned philosophers?



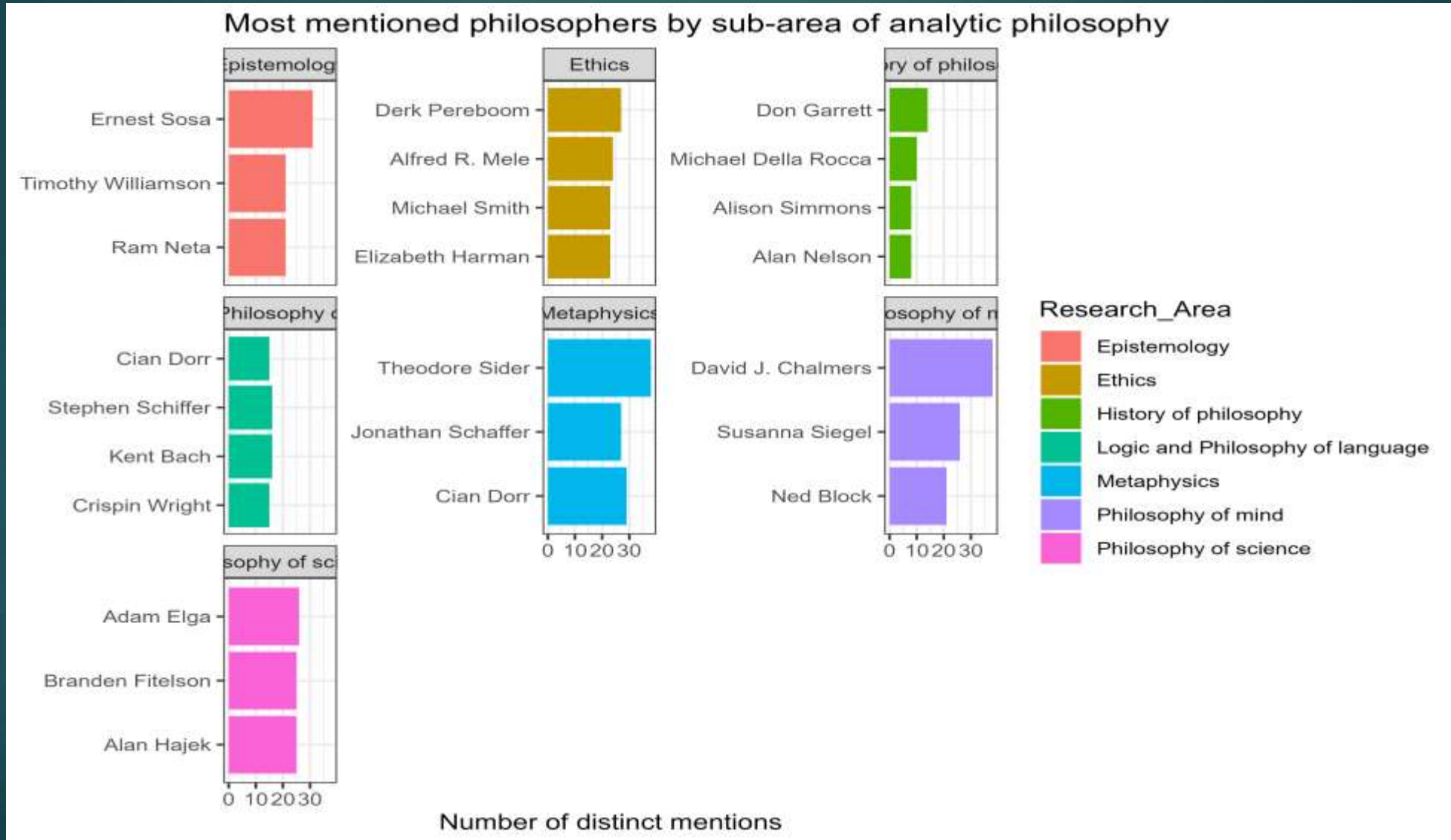
RESULTS:

3.1 Who are the most mentioned philosophers? (top_mentioned_phil)

Philosopher	N mentions
David J. Chalmers	103
Timothy Williamson	75
Jonthan Schaffer	70
John Hawthorne	68
James Pryor	67
Cian Dorr	66
Theodore Sider	60
Jason Stanley	56
Robert Stalnaker	55
Ernest Sosa	53

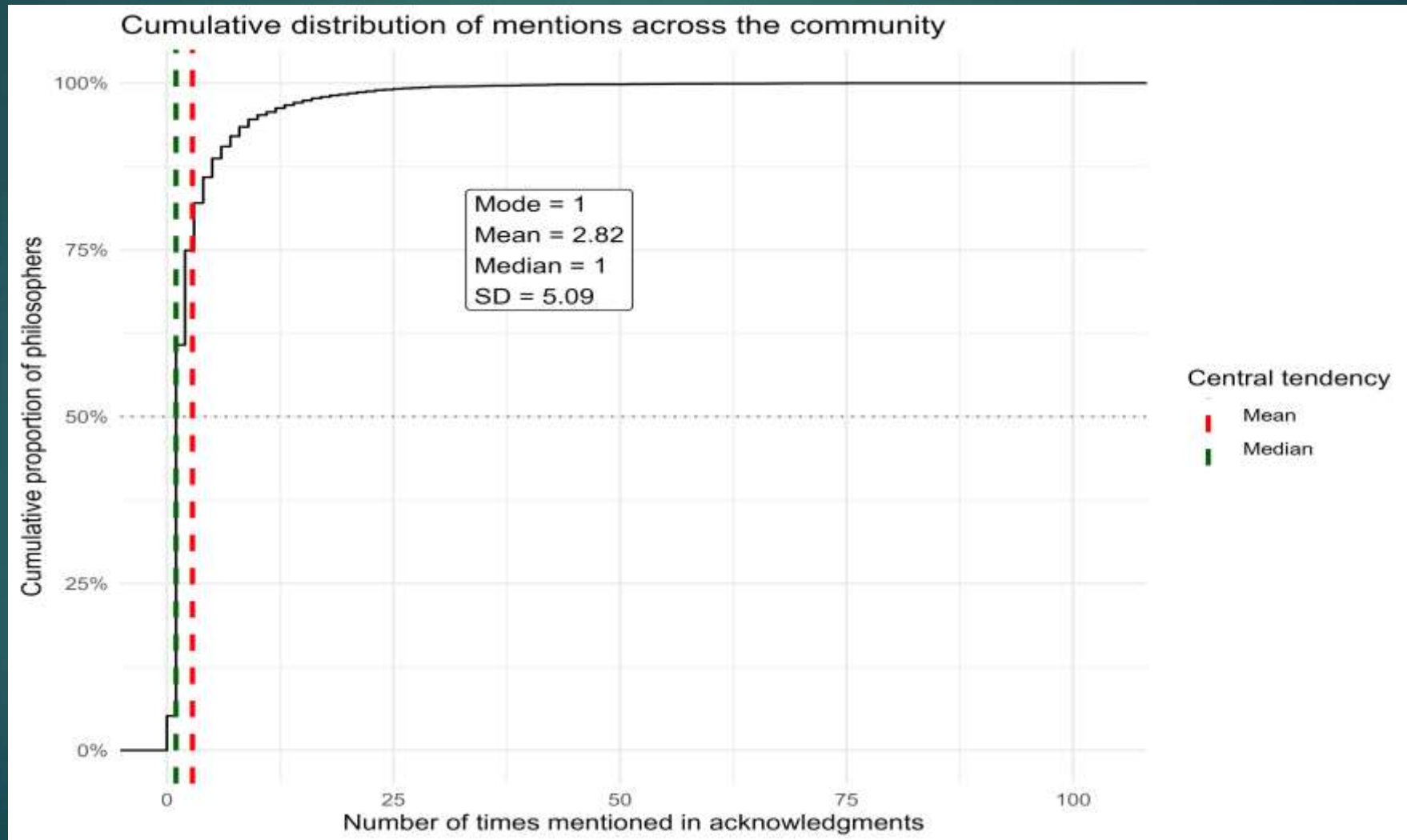
RESULTS:

3.2 Who are the most mentioned within each sub-area?



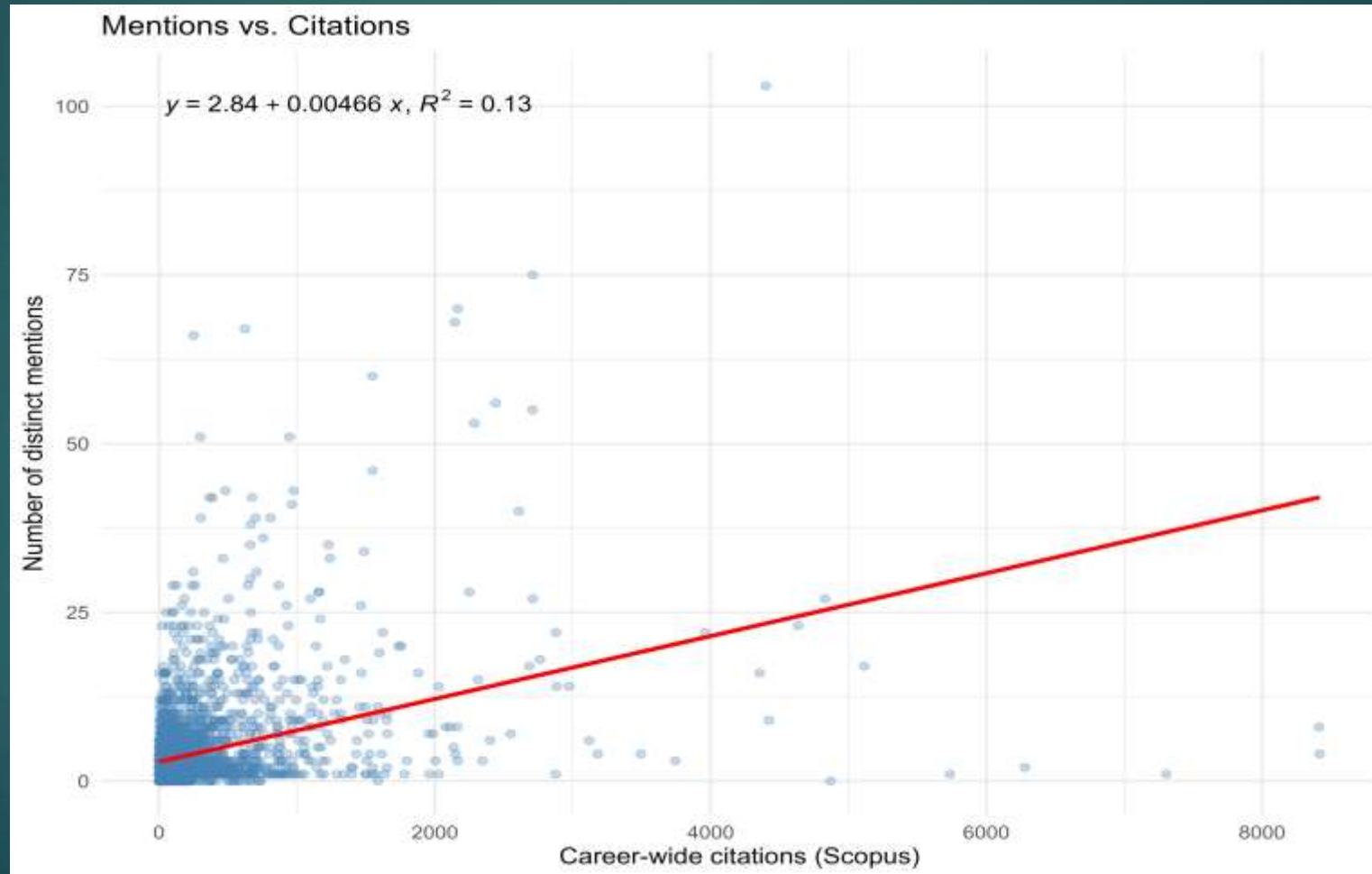
RESULTS:

3.3 How are mentions distributed among the community?



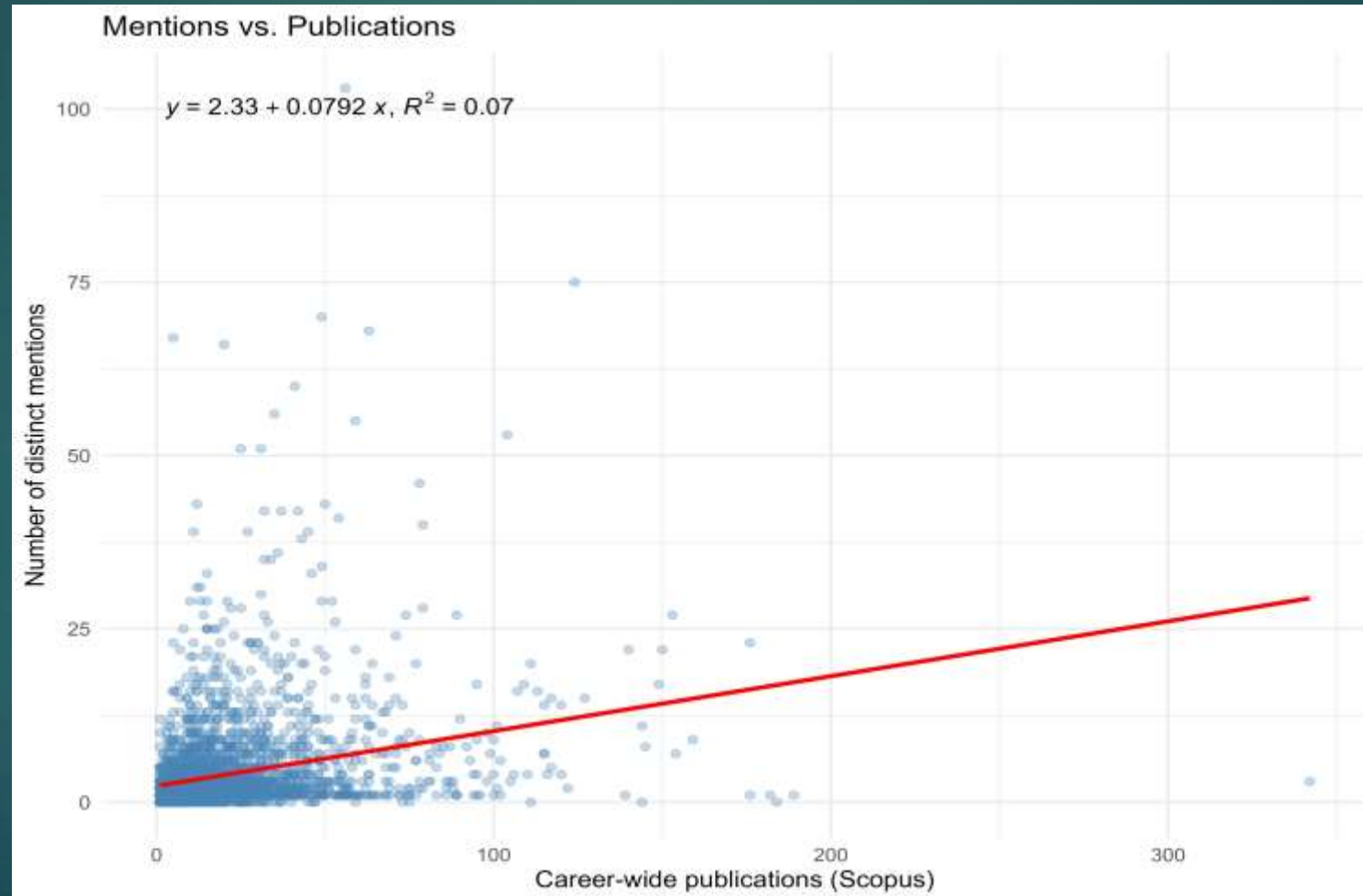
RESULTS:

3.4 Are mentions correlated with other prestige indicators?



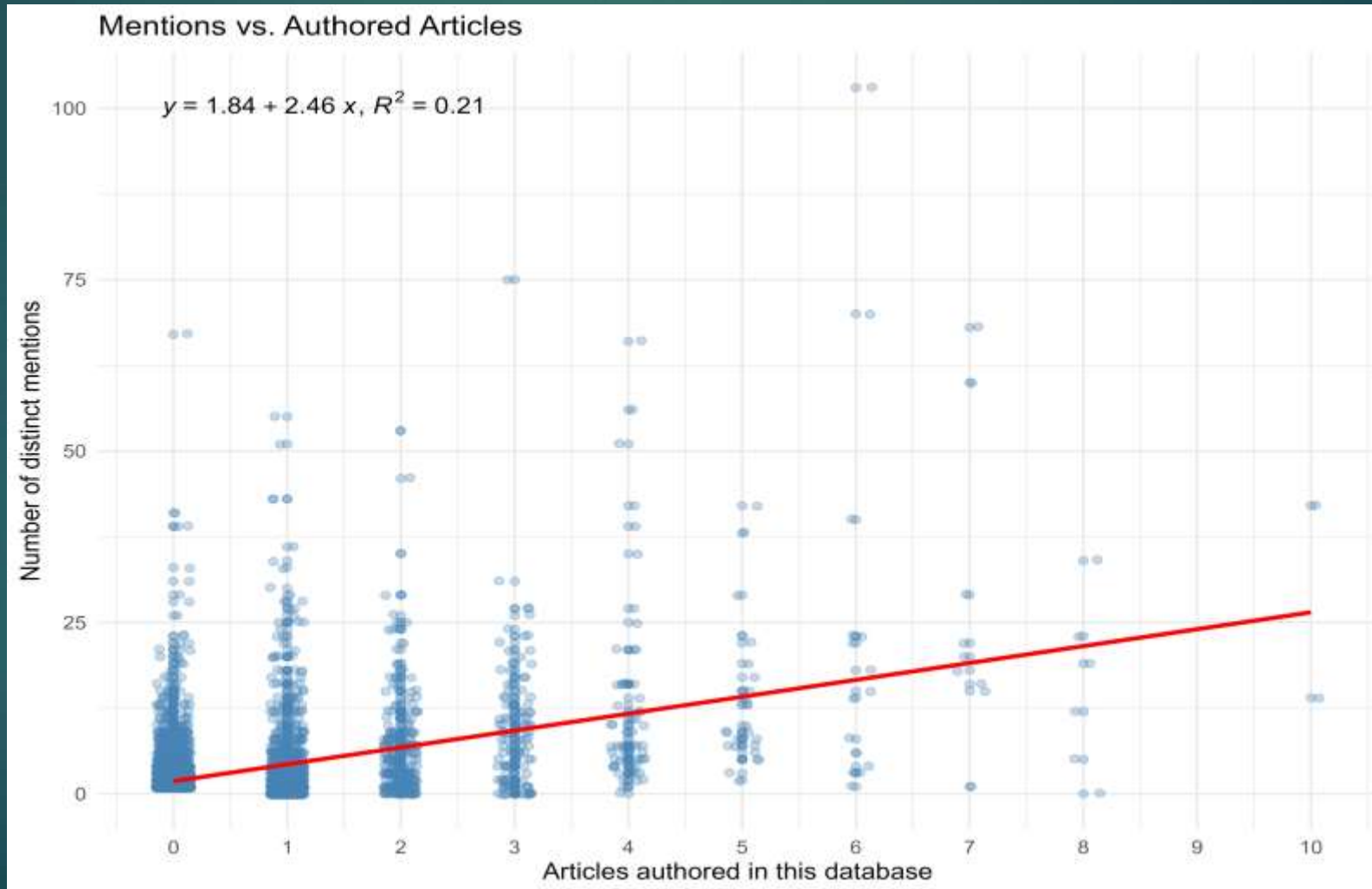
RESULTS:

3.4 Are mentions correlated with other prestige indicators?



RESULTS:

3.4 Are mentions correlated with other prestige indicators?



RESULTS:

3.5 Does gender affect the chances of accumulating mentions? (gender_tier_table)

Tier	N females	N males	Females (%)
Below median (0)	61	237	20.5
At median (1)	751	2472	23.3
Above median (2-5)	352	1305	21.2
Top 10% (6+)	113	559	16.8

CONCLUSIONS:

1) Production

- ▶ Top philosophers cluster around 7–10 articles, with frequent ties.
- ▶ Few elite institutions (MIT, NYU, Oxford) dominate the top of the ranking.
- ▶ Institutional productivity is heavily concentrated in the US and UK, reflecting the geographic connotation of analytic philosophy.

CONCLUSIONS:

2) Informal collaboration

- ▶ Nearly universal: 94.7% of articles and 96% of philosophers show at least one informal collaborator.
- ▶ Typical article/philosopher mentions 7–8 collaborators.
- ▶ Distribution is right-skewed, meaning that a small group of articles/individuals pulls the average up.

CONCLUSIONS:

3) Prestige

- ▶ Mentions are highly concentrated: one philosopher (Chalmers) dominates, whereas most receive 0–1 mentions.
- ▶ Only weak-to-moderate correlations between mentions and indicators of prestige, explaining at most about a fifth of the variation in mentions (using authored articles as independent variable).
- ▶ Gender gap is not uniform; it is concentrated at the top.